



Ballarat Wildlife Park

This is one experience you are unlikely to forget in a hurry. An hour and a half drive from Melbourne is the Ballarat Wildlife Park, that allows you to get up, close and personal with some of Australia's most famous native animals. Think hand-feeding kangaroos (who are friendly enough to surround you as long as you have enough snacks for them), petting koalas, and interacting with wombats and emus. You also get a chance to see the world's smallest penguin species, crocodiles and Siberian tigers. Insider tip: The Koala encounter costs AUD\$55 per person and you can pat the koala but the local state law bans you from holding or carrying it.



Great Ocean Road – Twelve Apostles

Embark on a scenic four-hour drive from Melbourne along the Great Ocean Road (considered one of the most picturesque drives in the world) and arrive at the stunning Twelve Apostles—a collection of limestone stacks off the shore of Port Campbell National Park. These mammoth structures rise from the sea and are best viewed from above—in a helicopter! A 16-minute ride costs AUD\$165 per person while a 25-minute ride is for AUD\$245 per person. While they were once connected to the mainland cliff, centuries of erosion has left them isolated from the shore, making them appear as lone majestic warriors. While there, visit Gibson Steps and climb down 86 stairs to the white sandy beach, surf or simply enjoy a walk along the soft sand with the cliff as your constant companion. Insider tip: There are only eight apostles still standing, the others having been eroded. Port Campbell is the nearest town and has some great accommodation in terms of hotels and camping sites.